

Adding coursework to the website

Quarto site · repo ahsanhabib-fin.github.io · local folder E:\ahsan-website

The loop for each new assignment

1. Save the file as `files/econometrics-hw2.qmd`. Put any data file it reads into `files/` too — knitr runs a `.qmd` from its own folder, so `read.csv("PSID1976.csv")` finds `files/PSID1976.csv`.
2. Open it in RStudio and click **Render** (Ctrl+Shift+K). You get `files/econometrics-hw2.html`.
3. **Check that HTML for R errors before publishing.** The course template sets `error = TRUE`, so broken code prints an error into the page instead of stopping the render. Search the file for “Error” and “not found”.
4. Open `projects.qmd`. Rows for HW 2–6 and the final project are parked in an HTML comment under the table — move one up into the table and replace `[Topic]` with the real topic.
5. Rebuild the site from the repo root:

```
cd E:\ahsan-website
quarto render
```

6. Commit and push. Live in a minute or two.

```
git add -A
git commit -m "Add Econometrics HW2"
git push
```

Four things that have already gone wrong

Rendering from the wrong folder. `quarto render` must run at `E:\ahsan-website`, where `_quarto.yml` lives. Run it from `files/` and it fails.

A --- rule with no blank line after it. Quarto reads it as the opening of a second YAML block and dies with a `YAMLError` pointing at a table separator row. Always leave a blank line after `---`.

Links to files that don't exist yet. Placeholder rows for unwritten assignments stay inside HTML comments so visitors don't hit 404s. Uncomment each one as the file lands.

Renaming a file locally doesn't change GitHub until the commit is pushed. Git shows the rename as a delete plus an add — that's normal.

The config that makes this work

`_quarto.yml` excludes `files/` from rendering, so homework sources stay in the repo without becoming public pages of their own:

```
project:
  type: website
  output-dir: docs
  render:
    - "*.qmd"
    - "!files/"
```

Rendered `.html` files in `files/` still get copied into `docs/files/`, because `projects.qmd` links to them. Note that the `render :` list is now the complete set of what gets built — a new page in a subfolder would have to be added to it.

One thing worth remembering

The repo is public, because GitHub Pages user sites are. Excluding a file from the rendered site does not hide it — anything committed is readable at github.com/ahsanhabib-fin/ahsanhabib-fin.github.io/blob/main/... For coursework in a course that is still running, that is worth a word with the instructor.